of Pakistan-based militants but actually orchestrated by the Pakistani government? In an important sense, this was the wrong question to ask. During the 1980s and the 1990s, the Pakistani government nurtured terror organizations such as Lashkar-e-Toiba as tools of asymmetric warfare against the Soviet occupation of Afghanistan and then against Indian rule in Jammu and Kashmir. The jihadis were armed and trained by elements of the Pakistani military and intelligence services, and funded by a sophisticated international financial network. In addition, they have enjoyed street-level popularity and remained a useful means of combating India's presence in Kashmir. Consequently, the Pakistani government balked at opportunities to shut them down completely.[28]

Now, however, the Pakistanis' strategy has given rise to what we call South Asia's "sorcerer's apprentice" problem. The jihadi organizations, like the magic brooms in Goethe's tale, have taken on a life of their own; along with the government, the army, and the intelligence services, such groups now comprise one of the main centers of gravity within Pakistan. As a result, the militants are in a position to establish and follow through on their own policy. Like Goethe's brooms, they often act against the interests of their creators, attacking security personnel, assassinating government officials, and seizing large swaths of territory within Pakistan, as well as launching attacks on India that could trigger a regional conflagration.[29] The relevant question, then, is not whether the Pakistani government was directly responsible for the Mumbai attacks. Rather, it is who will now play the role of sorcerer and rein in the jihadis.

The natural candidates for this role would be either the Pakistani or the Indian government. But the Mumbai attacks have made painfully clear that neither side is currently up to the task. The Pakistani government has solemnly pledged not to allow its soil to be used as a launching ground for anti-Indian terrorism.[30] But the Mumbai assault demonstrates that Pakistan is unable to make good on this promise. The Indians, for their part, are unable to anticipate or repel such attacks. Although the Indian government had received credible warnings of a seaborne terrorist operation, the Mumbai attackers caught the Indians completely unawares. And once the